



“STEERING SBI INTO THE FUTURE”

C.S. Setty, Chairman of the State Bank of India,
talks about his plans for the bank, the strategy for the
future, and technology, among other things

PHOTOS BY **MILIND SHELTE**

Q: What have been your priorities since you took over as chairman?

A: I have spent over 36 years at SBI, but being the Chairman of the largest institution in financial services is a great honour and also a greater responsibility. It's a mix of continuity and change for me in the sense that I've been a part of this board for the last four years, which means that many things we collectively have been doing as management, some of these initiatives will continue in terms of digitalisation, increased focus on financial inclusion, SMEs... Additionally I would like to build on our network, on the digital capabilities that we invested in and bring consistency in our perfor-

mance and increase the productivity of both digital and brand channels, and more importantly, create a resilience in our operations... To get this idea of consistency, productivity and resilience across the bank, I, along with four MDs, have initiated the largest staff outreach programme ever attempted at SBI. Physically, we are going to our zonal offices and meeting very critical components of our machinery, that is managers [of our] 22,500 branches. We have more than 500 regional offices, more than 100 zonal offices, 17 local aid offices, [and] we are trying to meet everyone and convey the same theme on consistency, productivity, and resilience.